

The Swift Herald

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FEATURES

How I Got My Visa to France

Matthew Kepnes · Nomadic Matt

I've been in love with France ever since my first trip to Bordeaux in 2010. Friends I had met back in Thailand showed me around the area and introduced me to French culture. It was my first time in France and I loved the food, the wine, and the people.

But that love became an obsession when, after Bordeaux, I stepped out of the Paris metro and onto the Champs Élysées. The lights, the energy, the mystique! There was magic in the air. I felt like I had known the city my entire life and I was simply returning home.

Since then, Paris has had a firm grip on my heart. Over the years, I spent countless visits exploring France and Paris in particular. I've run tours in the city and I spent a few months living there in 2019.

Last August, after yet another sojourn, I thought to myself, "What if I moved back?"

I was growing a bit tired of the NYC dating scene, the rising cost of living, and felt like creatively, I was in a rut. With AI coming for creators like me and the industry changing, I was a little lost on what, career wise, would come next.

In short, I needed a change.

And Paris seemed like the best place to go.

It's cheaper than NYC, I had friends there already, I've always wanted to learn French, it would make a great base for exploring Europe, and I could start writing my next book there. There's nothing like a change in scenery to get the creativity flowing!

But the question remained: how do you move to France?

After all, they don't have a digital nomad visa, and you're limited to three months if you visit on your regular Schengen tourist visa.

Well, it turns out that it's not actually that hard. (And while I can only speak for Americans, I suspect the criteria are similar for Canadians, Aussies, Kiwis, and other "developed" nations.)

If you want to move to France, you have four main options:

Student visa

Long-term visitor visa

Talent visa

The student visa is pretty straightforward. You need to enroll in a full-time university program and show you have enough funds to support yourself (around 600 Euros per month). A friend is currently there on this visa, as she is doing a nine-month intensive French program to become

fluent. You still have to apply for the visa, but if you're enrolled in an accredited school, you'll likely get approved. Another benefit to this visa is that you can work part-time on it!

But this visa is contingent on being in school, so if you leave or quit, it's voided. However, when you are done, you can change this to a "job seekers" visa, which can give you up to another six months in France (or more depending on how long your program was).

I thought about applying for the entrepreneur visa, but the application process is pretty complex and can take months to be approved. You have to set up your business in France — and that is a lot of paperwork. You have to show that your business makes money, has clients (at least one of them being French), and can support you full time (you have to make at least the French minimum wage). They will scrutinize your assets and financials a lot and you'll need to register your business in France and pay French taxes.

Additionally, France offers a talent visa. If you're an expert in your field (with verifiable accreditations and accolades), this could be a good visa to apply for, especially if you plan to stay in France for a long time and want to physically work there. But, again, you'll need to have some source of income and plan to do physical business in the France. If you're not an academic but someone in the arts, you have to show how you are going to add to the "culture of France" in some way.

While I would meet the requirements for both those visas, the process for either would have been time consuming, and, since I'm not sure France is going to be my forever home, I decided not to go through that process.

So I went with the long-term visitor visa, officially called VLS-TS visiteur. This allows me to stay up to 12 months in France and is renewable in the country. It does come with a lot of restrictions, however: I can't physically work here and I am not allowed into the French social welfare system.

It's also the visa a lot of Americans (and most retirees) are coming in on. If you have passive income or retirement savings and just want to live in France, this is a good option for you. It allows you to set up a bank account and it can be renewed pretty much indefinitely.

The paperwork for this visa (which I'll get into in a bit) essentially comes down to whether or not you can support yourself. French authorities want to make sure you won't be a burden on the system.

My biggest question centered around whether or not I could "work" on this visa. A lot of creators and digital nomads are applying for — and getting — this visa.

But remember: you aren't allowed to work on this visa so how are you going to work if you can't work?

So let me take a moment to talk about "work" from a legal standpoint.

20 Sheet Pan Dinners for Easy Weeknights

Lindsay · Pinch of Yum

Sheet pan dinners are one of my favorite weeknight magic tricks. Minimal prep, fewer dishes, everything roasting together in the oven... it's more than ideal. When life feels busy (which is... most of the time), these are the types of recipes I come back to again and again.

This list of dinners is full of the recipes we make on repeat in my house – flavor-packed, low-effort, and super flexible. You've got cozy options, fresh-feeling meals, and a few fun little twists. It's a little bit of everything, all built for real life.

If you're looking for dinners that don't require a ton of thinking (or cleanup), you're in the right place. Pick one, toss it on a sheet pan, and let the oven do the heavy lifting!

Sheet Pan Chicken Pitas with Tzatziki

Part bowl, part salad, part sandwich folded up into any kind of bread you like, and I'm here for it in every form.

150 reviews / 5 average

[make this recipe](#)

Sheet Pan Meatballs with Tomato Salad and Green Sauce

Juicy little sheet pan meatballs that are salty, zesty, briney, and so so delicious. Pile them on tzatziki, spoon some punchy green sauce over top, and serve with a simple salad and crusty bread.

47 reviews / 5 average

[make this recipe](#)

Liz's Roasted Broccoli Salad

This Roasted Broccoli Salad is EVERYTHING! Bright lemon, crisped-up bacon, tangy feta, and it's all built around a big bowl of roasted broccoli. A true hero of a meal!

63 reviews / 5 average

[make this recipe](#)

Harissa Meatballs with Whipped Feta

These Harissa Meatballs with Whipped Feta are perfect for an easy SOS dinner! Store-bought meatballs, bell peppers, zucchini, harissa, and whipped feta all in one bowl. YUMMY!

39 reviews / 5 average

[make this recipe](#)

Sheet Pan Salmon with Dill Potatoes

Simple and delicious salmon and potatoes roasted on a sheet pan, and covered in a garlic dill butter sauce! One of my family's favorite dinners.

23 reviews / 4.9 average

[make this recipe](#)

Sheet Pan Jambalaya: maximum flavor, minimal dishes. Sausage, peppers, onions, shrimp, and cauliflower rice all roasted up on a sheet pan. Big flavor, easy dinner!

30 reviews / 4.9 average

[make this recipe](#)

Sheet Pan Shrimp and Cauli Rice

This Sheet Pan Shrimp and Cauli Rice is the easiest sheet pan dinner! Shrimp, peas, cauliflower rice, seasonings, and Rosso pesto sauce all come together on one pan for a delicious springy meal.

30 reviews / 4.9 average

[make this recipe](#)

Fall Favorite Maple-Mustard Tempeh Bowls

These tempeh bowls are a true fall favorite! Massaged kale, sweet potatoes, roasty marinated maple-mustard tempeh, crunchy apple, and an unexpected pile of briney sauerkraut.

25 reviews / 4.9 average

[make this recipe](#)

Sheet Pan Chicken and Sweet Potato Meal Prep

Spicy Chicken and Sweet Potato Meal Prep Magic! Just chicken, sweet potatoes, broccoli, avocado, and seasonings. 3 big sheet pans + 45 minutes = healthy meals for a week!

73 reviews / 4.8 average

[make this recipe](#)

Sheet Pan Breakfast Burritos with Creamy Chipotle Sauce

I absolutely love these breakfast burritos. Creamy scrambled eggs, roasted garlic veggies, smoky cheese, and refried beans all wrapped up in a delicious burrito!

11 reviews / 5 average

[make this recipe](#)

Sheet Pan Chicken Tinga Bowls

These Chicken Tinga Bowls are the BEST! Made in just 15 minutes, all on a sheet pan. My favorite kind of meal prep!

Claude and the Constitution: Questions Congress Should Ask Before Renewing Section 702

Ryan Goodman · Just Security

By law, on April 20, 2026, a broad tool for intercepting the communications of foreigners abroad – Section 702 of the Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Act – will sunset, unless Congress decides to renew it. This deadline gives Congress an unusual opportunity to examine the executive branch's use of this surveillance law, which has been criticized for its ability to sweep in communications of Americans, and to consider its use in the context of other government surveillance tools and authorities.

To be sure, having worked in the government, we believe that historically Section 702 has provided the government with an indispensable national security tool with respect to the NSA and other agencies' detecting foreign threats. But there has also been meaningful bipartisan interest in reforms to the tool. We recognize important long-standing questions and concerns it raises about Americans' and others' privacy rights and the parameters governing how the law functions.

What makes this moment different is the convergence of two factors: (1) the government's rapidly expanding deployment of artificial intelligence in its surveillance programs; and (2) greater distrust of government actions involving Americans' First Amendment political freedoms and Fourth Amendment privacy rights, which courts have repeatedly found to have been violated by this administration.

In order to facilitate robust deliberation, we provide the following questions for Members of Congress to ask executive branch officials as part of the Section 702 renewal process. Journalists and the public could – and should – also demand answers to these questions.

On Claude and Defense Department Surveillance

Anthropic, the company that has developed the Claude suite of AI tools, has sued the Department of Defense (DOD). In its complaint, the company objects to removing constraints on Claude's use for "mass surveillance of Americans." In its successful motion for a preliminary injunction, Anthropic objects, among other things, to "allowing Claude's use on classified systems to surveil Americans en masse."

The questions for Members of Congress to ask are:

Under what specific circumstances does the U. S. government believe it can engage in mass surveillance of Americans? For what purposes? Relying on what authorities? With what prior authorization and oversight? Using which tools?

How does the administration seek to use Claude (or other AI) to surveil Americans?

Is any such program approved by a court, including the FISC (the Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Court)? Has the FISA Court been given a comprehensive description of all AI systems currently operating in the Section 702 program? In other surveillance programs?

Under what circumstances specifically do you believe the DOD could engage in surveillance of Americans? What potential use cases for AI does it believe would be lawful in such circumstances, and why?

Given the very narrow circumstances in which the U. S. military may ever be used for domestic purposes, why does the DOD have any need or intent to surveil Americans? Would such use depend on invocation of the Insurrection Act?

What can be made public about any such program, so we do not have a recurrence of the "215" program (a surveillance program involving millions of Americans' telephone metadata, which was considered unwise if not illegal by many after being revealed by Edward Snowden)?

Do any other executive departments or agencies have any initiatives of any sort, whether planned or existing, for using AI for the mass surveillance of U. S. persons? If so, which AI companies' products would be used for those purposes? If contracts or subcontracts exist, please provide those contracts and subcontracts.

On the Fourth Amendment

The Department's use or intended use of AI may run afoul of the Fourth Amendment.

The constitutional framework : In *Carpenter v. United States* (2018), the Supreme Court held that the FBI's warrantless acquisition of an individual's cell site location information over several months violated the Fourth Amendment. The Court wrote: "Although such records are generated for commercial purposes, that distinction does not negate Carpenter's anticipation of privacy ... [T]he time-stamped data provides an intimate window into a person's life, revealing not only his particular movements, but through them his 'familial, political, professional, religious, and sexual associations.'" The Court was quoting Justice Sotomayor's concurrence in *United States v. Jones* (2012), in which she wrote: "GPS monitoring generates a precise, comprehensive record of a person's public movements that reflects a wealth of detail about her familial, political, professional, religious, and sexual associations."

A Feb. 26, 2026 statement by Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei said:

"Mass domestic surveillance. We support the use of AI for lawful foreign intelligence and counterintelligence missions. But using these systems for mass domestic surveillance is incompatible with democratic values. AI-driven mass surveillance presents serious, novel risks to our fundamental liberties. To the extent that such surveillance is

Yeat Redefines the Album Rollout and Ye Drops ‘BULLY’: Everything We Loved In Music This Week

Hypebeast

All of the biggest music headlines in one place and playlist. Updated live throughout the week.

Ye's BULLY Lands on Streaming Services

First came the billboards. Then came the supposed listening parties. And even so, with a history of delays and false release dates, we didn't know if it would actually drop. Posts began circulating that it wouldn't drop this go around, once again. The mixing wasn't finalized. The listening parties actually went down, with Ye even showing up at the LA one, and come Saturday morning, BULLY actually landed on all streaming services. The 18-track follow-up to Donda comes equipped with contributions from Travis Scott , Andre Troutman, Don Toliver and Peso Pluma .

Bladee Drops Off New Two-Pack

After presenting his first solo sonic offering of 2026 back in February with "Magic Misery," Bladee has dropped off a two-pack of tracks: "Love Is A State" and "Eyelash." Whether this marks the start of a rollout remains to be seen, but we're optimistic.

ADL Arrives

At long last, after totally uprooting the traditional album rollout and redefining the modern strategy, Yeat has formally dropped off his A DANGEROUS LYFE / A DANGEROUS LOVE double album. Early favorites include the opening track "Purpose General," 070 feature "Went Wrong," and the Dijon -sampling "Dangerous House."

Jessie Reyez Surprises With \$TILL PAID

In honor of PAID IN MEMORIES' first anniversary, Jessie Reyez dropped a calm EP to commemorate the occasion. The five-track offering is titled \$TILL PAID and features one appearance by Stormzy .

MIKE and Earl Share Second POMPEII/UTILITY Collab Cut, "Leadbelly"

As the anticipated POMPEII/UTILITY release date nears and surprise listening parties ramp up, Earl Sweatshirt and MIKE have presented the second offering from the project, "Leadbelly." The pair pass the track back and forth in another captivating prelude to the LP.

gamma. Moves Into Fashion

As fashion and music continue to merge in unprecedented manners, Larry Jackson's gamma. seeks to expand its artistic universe in its first-ever foray into the fashion world. In an exclusive to Hypebeast, Larry Jackson shares more about Maison gamma., the music media imprint's new

merchandising sector, with the inaugural drop released in partnership with Brooklyn-based Savant Studios.

Yeat Takes His Tracklist to the Top

The night before dropping ADL , Yeat lifted the veil on the full tracklist. It wasn't announced via Instagram post or billboard, but rather, projected upon the Capitol Records Tower in Hollywood. The rapper shared a video on socials of himself posted up (à la mob boss, once again) at the top of the tower eating a multiple-course meal. The camera pans out to the full tower, which features the entire album tracklist running down.

Matthew M. Williams Tells Us He Just Heard Travis Scott's New Album

[View this post on Instagram](#)

A post shared by HYPEBEAST (@hypebeast)

We sat down with Matthew M. Williams after the news of his appointment as Oakley's Creative Director of Apparel, Footwear, and Accessories broke. The full conversation is dropping soon, but we couldn't wait to share what he had to say about Travis Scott's newest studio album. Williams has, in fact, heard it and says it sounds like nothing the rapper has ever done before.

Jay-Z Adds "Extra Innings"

Now there is officially no excuse for us to be there. HOV tacked on a third night to his July run of shows at Yankee Stadium, now performing three straight nights from Friday, July 10, to Sunday, July 12.

Yeat's Full-Page Feature Reveal

At the top of the week, Yeat took to none other than The New York Times to reveal the full slate of featured artists set to appear on ADL . Centered around another mob boss-inspired image of Twizzy comes an impressive (and surprising) curation of A-list contributing artists. The ad reveals a wide range of featured contributors from across the board, spanning everyone from Elton John to Don Toliver . Other names include NBA Youngboy , Joji , 070 Shake , Kid Cudi , BNYX , Swizz Beatz , Grimes , Julia Wolf , Dylan Brady , Rampa, Synthetic, Lycid and Sapjer.

Fcukers Makes Formal Debut: Ö

If you don't know the names Shanny Wise and Jackson Walker, tap in now. Fcukers may be easier to remember. As they continue their ascent, the New York City-based electronic duo has just dropped off their long-form debut. Dubbed Ö , the 11-song project was produced by Kenneth Blume (Kenny Beats) and features additional prod contributions from Dylan Brady.

Bite: Smoked Pigeon and Other Subnatural Delights

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · *Gastropod*

In this week's bite-sized episode, Nicky travels to the campus of Duke University, in Durham, North Carolina, for a day of talks and tastings exploring the shifting status of stinky cheese, offal, insects, and other funky foods. At different times and places, these foods have been regarded as "subnatural"—low-class, disgusting, even unhygienic. But what does categorizing these foods as subnatural say about us, and what happens when we decide that they're desirable, after all?

Here are links to the peculiar but fascinating events, ideas, and books we discuss in this bite-sized episode. Subnature: Architecture's Other Environments, David Gissen

The term "subnature" was coined by architectural theorist David Gissen in 2009 to describe the less desirable aspects of the built environment: puddles, pollution, and pigeons. His book explores the historical assumptions behind this mostly unquestioned hierarchy in which light, air, and greenery are perceived as "good," while the equally natural dust, dirt, and weeds are unwelcome.

It also includes a selection of projects by contemporary architects and preservationists that engage with historical perceptions of subnatural environments and attempt to re-imagine them for the future. For example, Gissen includes both a discussion of anti-pigeon spikes and a description of the Brooklyn Pigeon Project, in which architecture firm Aranda/Lasch developed a set of algorithms and tools to help humans re-visualize the city from the point of view of a flock of pigeons. Subnature and Culinary Culture, Duke University

By collaborating with colleagues from a wide range of departments at Duke, as well as chefs, cheese-makers, and foragers from the local community, Tom Parker, a visiting scholar from Vassar, created a campus-wide program of events, talks, installations, and edible experiences exploring what the idea of subnature might mean in terms of food, and why particular foods, texture, and flavors have been marginalized in certain societies.

Highlights included the construction of a smokehouse on the lawn outside the university president's offices, as well as a dinner in which the chefs from five local restaurants came together to showcase local subnatural ingredients prepared in transformative ways. On the menu: car-park roasted quail, cooked using a set-up that chef Matt Kelly described as "redneck ingenuity," and sturgeon coated in a crust of corn fungus and its own heart and collagen, smoked in the Duke smokehouse.

"Sturgeon: Its Roe, Marrow, Collagen, & Heart. Lacto-Fermented Onions. Our Soured Cream. Saltwort." As prepared by chefs Kim Floresca and Daniel Ryan, [ONE] Restaurant. Photo by Nicola Twilley. "How Wine Became Metropolitan," Edible Geography

This is the post about David Gissen's new map of France's wine regions that started the ball rolling by introducing Tom Parker to the idea of subnature. Gissen represents wine appellations as stops on a subway line rather than as geographic territories in an attempt to communicate the relationship between each region, rather than their legal boundaries.

The Metro Wine Map of France, David Gissen

The post Bite: Smoked Pigeon and Other Subnatural Delights appeared first on Gastropod. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Live, Life, Travel...Forget the Bucket!

Anne Gordon · Live Life Travel

Live, Life, Travel...

FORGET THE BUCKET

WRITTEN BY ANNE GORDON, OWNER & LEISURE TRAVEL ADVISOR,

LIVE LIFE TRAVEL, LLC

When my 12-year old son told me that he had a “bucket list,” I was surprised by my mixed emotions. On one-hand, I was so proud that I had inspired him at such a young age to be so passionate about travel that he had his own list of “must see destinations.” However, when I think about a “bucket list” it conjures up feelings of people who almost missed out because they waited to enjoy life until it was almost too late, which is not how I want to live, not how I raise my son, and definitely the complete opposite of WHAT we should all be aiming for... Live Life Travel.

Perhaps it is just a saying and I am taking it too literally; however, I view it as a mindset that we can be changing at home starting with our own children in very engaging, fun and educational ways.

Instead of a “Bucket List,” we can make a conscious decision to start building “Life Lists” with our families from a very young age, which then creates both life and family goals.

Here are some of the awesome benefits:

Increased sense of community within the family through shared goals

Better communication encouraging teamwork at home

Education – Geography (we recommend not going to any destination before all children have completed their in-classroom education)

Budgeting – Goals

Parents become role models for their children in terms of prioritizing family time, being able to unplug from work, taking all of their paid vacation time

TRAVEL BENEFITS FOR KIDS: Increased independence, self-esteem and self-confidence as well as developing intellectual curiosity, better cooperation skills and adaptability and increased tolerance and respectfulness of others. Education beyond the classroom... learning about different cultures, languages, history, currencies, museums/art as well as becoming global citizens.

Vacation Benefits for Adults: Lowers stress, Heart disease prevention, Increased productivity, Better sleep, Irreplaceable memories and Experiences with your children (set goals for before the 1st child leaves for college).

Naturally, as parents, our biggest challenges will always be:

Having enough time

Having enough money

Or a combination of both at the same time

We call this the “Time/Money Ratio,” and it is why planning and having goals is essential. For example, I made a commitment for my son and I to always spend February Break together when he started Kindergarten and since then, we have. However, February has become an extremely busy month for me and he’s turning 13 (new “Life Stage”) so we are re-assessing our Family Travel Goals.

Perhaps it would make more sense for him to fly alone to Florida and spend more time with his Grandparents that week. This is a perfect example of why my family needs to re-assess our own goals right now. We also only have 5 years before he graduates from High School and we both know that we have certain places that we want to travel to together before then that we will need to save and plan for.

Every family will have different obstacles, but the objective is to make a commitment, then work together towards the goal that is important to everyone. For your children, this will be the first of many “life lists.” Encourage your children – along with yourself – to seize the opportunity when it presents itself. Studying abroad or “volunteer travel” are both rewarding experiences for young travelers.

If you are not sure where to start, speak to a travel advisor for a consultation and professional planning. LiveLifeTravel.world

The post Live, Life, Travel...Forget the Bucket! appeared first on Live Life Travel .

Air Fryer Chicken Thighs

Lindsay · Pinch of Yum

These Chicken Thighs Are a New House Favorite!

Guys, I've been holding myself back from making these chicken thighs every single night. They're so good. They go with almost anything, they're extra juicy and crisped, and the kids and adults in my family BOTH approve!

I love them with so many things:

roasted potato wedges and a cucumber salad

a creamy pasta

a wrap, sandwich, or salad

a baked potato and some roasted veggies

just eating straight with a side of your favorite sauce! (all my favorite sauces here !)

The chicken is so so flavor-crusted and so finger-licking yummy that I still can hardly believe you can make it in the air fryer.

I have to fight my kids not to eat it all off the cutting board before it even makes it to the table.

If you've made our air fryer chicken breasts (also amazing), the flavor on these chicken thighs is more savory. The OG chicken breast recipe has a brown sugar and smoked paprika base, whereas this one has paprika, garlic and onion, and a bit of oregano.

I have been LOVING these with a smoky paprika aioli (I'll include that in the recipe notes – it is so yummy). I am making myself hungry just thinking about it.

Hope you guys love it!

How To Make Air Fryer Chicken Thighs

1

Trim Chicken Thighs.

Optional, but I often cut off any little bits of fat that are on the edges of the chicken thighs.

2

Toss with Spices!

Get those chicken thighs totally coated! Like so.

3

Air Fry for 11-13 Minutes.

Place in a single layer in the air fryer to cook evenly!

4

It's done!

Do a quick temp check – the inside should reach a minimum of 165 degrees (I use this meat thermometer to check).

5

Cut and Serve!

My daughter and my husband couldn't wait for me to finish the photos. ☺ I like to chop the chicken into bite-sized pieces and squeeze a bit of lemon over the whole thing! So yummy.

5 Stars 4 Stars 3 Stars 2 Stars 1 Star

5 from 15 reviews

Author: Lindsay

Total Time: 28 minutes

Yield: 4 servings 1 x

These air fryer chicken thighs are SO good. Super juicy, deeply golden, and ready in 15 minutes! Such an easy recipe that my whole family loves.

1.25 pounds boneless skinless chicken thighs

1 1/2 teaspoons paprika

1 teaspoon oregano

1/2 teaspoon garlic powder

1/2 teaspoon onion powder

3/4 teaspoon salt (I've been using a fine-grained table salt for this)

a few cracks of freshly ground black pepper

1 tablespoon olive oil

squeeze of lemon to finish

Cook Mode

Prevent your screen from going dark

Trim the Chicken Thighs: Optional, but I usually cut off the little bits of fat (the chunkier white strips) from the edges of the chicken thighs.

Season the Chicken: Toss the chicken thighs with the spices and olive oil. For the best flavor, let it marinate anywhere from 15 minutes to 2-3 hours in the fridge. (Also fine to skip if you're short on time!)

Air Fry Chicken: Air fry at 375 for 11-13 minutes, until deeply golden and a bit crisped on the outside, and at least 165 degrees Fahrenheit on the inside. (I use a meat

Peanuts: Peril and Promise

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Despite their diminutive scale, peanuts play an outsized role in American culture. Peanut butter has long been a mainstay of the American lunchbox, with its sticky, slightly sweet nuttiness flavoring the memories of generation after generation of kids. And it's hard to imagine ballgames without, as the song goes, peanuts and Cracker Jacks (which, of course, also contain peanuts). But today, peanuts are the source of both hope and fear: while there's been a surprisingly steep rise of peanut allergies in recent decades that can—though rarely—lead to death, peanut butter is also the basis of a medical therapy used to save the lives of millions of children around the world. This episode, we discover how the humble peanut got to be such a big deal.

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Eating the Wild: Bushmeat, Game, and the Fuzzy Line Between Them

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

It's a safe bet that your recent media diet has included the words “wet market,” “zoonotic disease,” and “pangolin,” as experts take a pause from discussing COVID-19's spread and impact to speculate on the virus's origins. This episode, we're digging into the larger story behind those words, that of our relationship to eating wild animals: how and why have our attitudes to wild meat shifted over time? Why is it that deer shot by a hunter in the U. S. is game, but monkey caught in the Democratic Republic of Congo is bushmeat? With the help of Gina Rae La Cerva, author of the new book, *Feasting Wild*, we explore what we gain and lose by eating wild, from the lost primeval forests of Europe to Robin Hood, and from smoked monkey to bird spit.

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Caffeine: The World's Most Popular Drug

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

The Interstitium (Radiolab)

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Guest episode: In this episode we introduce you to a part of our bodies that was invisible to Western scientists until about five years ago; it's called “the interstitium,” a vast network of fluid channels inside the tissues around our organs that scientists have just begun to see, name, and understand. Along the way we look at how new technologies rub up against long-standing beliefs, and how millions of scientists and doctors failed to see what was right in front (and inside!) of their noses. We also find out how mapping the anatomy of this hidden infrastructure may help solve one of the fundamental mysteries of cancer, and perhaps provide a bridge between ancient and modern medicine. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Beans, Beans, the Magical Fruit

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Botanically, bean pods are indeed fruits, and, honestly, they are also pretty magical. And we're clearly not the only ones to think that: beans are the unsung hero of history. The fact that they were domesticated an astonishing seven different times in different places around the world shows how essential beans were to early humans, wherever they lived; in Europe, Italian author and polymath Umberto Eco credits the bean with saving civilization itself. Lately, however, the humble bean has found its fan base declining. In Northern Europe, Australia, Canada, and the United States, most people barely eat beans at all. This episode—our love song to beans—we're exploring the story of the bean's fall from grace, as well as the heirloom varieties and exclusive club that are making beans cool again. Plus, we visit with the Ugandan breeder working on Beans 2.0, which will take a third less time to cook. But can anybody do anything about one of beans' most notorious side-effects? Yes, we're talking farts: we're on the case to discover whether scientists can develop a gas-free bean. Listen in as we spill the beans on one of our favorite foods.

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Prescription Dinner: Can Meals Be Medicine?

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

A tablespoon of it will kill you, but most of us feel like death without it: we're talking about caffeine this episode. Inspired by a listener question — does green tea have more or less caffeine than black? and what about yerba mate? — Cynthia and Nicky explore the history and science of the world's most popular drug. Listen in as we discover the curious effect of birth control pills on how our bodies process it, calculate how much of an edge it gives athletes, and learn what dolphin dissection and the American Constitution have to do with each other, and with caffeine.

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The Billion Dollar War Behind U.S. Rum (Planet Money)

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

When you buy a bottle of rum in the United States, by law nearly all the federal taxes on that rum must be sent to Puerto Rico and the U. S. Virgin Islands. It's an unusual system that Congress designed decades ago to help fund these two U. S. territories. In 2021 alone, these rum tax payments added up to more than \$700 million. Puerto Rico and the Virgin Islands split the money according to how much rum each territory produces. And the territories produce a lot of it — especially Puerto Rico, which single handedly supplies the majority of the rum that Americans drink. But in 2008, the U. S. Virgin Islands pulled off a coup. It convinced one of the largest rum brands in the world, Captain Morgan, to abandon Puerto Rico and to shift its operations to the tiny island of St. Croix. This was the beginning of the Rum Wars. Listen in to the story of how this war turned the two territories into bitter rivals—and put hundreds of millions of U. S. taxpayer money in the pockets of big liquor companies. (Guest episode)

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OXO, Cuisinart, and Julia Child: The Secret (Accessible) History Behind Your Kitchen

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

We've all heard that what you eat affects your health—but doctors prescribing dinner? It's real: Medically tailored meals are specifically designed to treat conditions such as kidney disease, diabetes, and heart disease, as well nourish people going through chemotherapy and radiation. Today, in a handful of places around the US, eligible patients can receive them for free, prescribed by their medical provider and reimbursed by their health insurance. There's even legislation in Congress that would roll this program out nationwide. This episode, Gastropod investigates: how do medically tailored meals work? From the science of how nutritionally designed dinners can affect disease progression, to the economics behind why it makes sense for taxpayers and insurers to invest in food, to the tricky logistics of bringing prescription meals to the masses, listen in now for the scoop on one of the biggest stories in healthcare.

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Mexico moves to combat pollution following Guardian investigations

Erin McCormick, The Guardian, and Verónica García de León, Quinto Elemento Lab · The Guardian Environment

After stories revealed high levels of contamination in neighborhood around factory processing US toxic waste, government announces sweeping array of tactics

The Mexican government has announced it will pursue a sweeping array of tactics to combat industrial pollution, from \$4.8m in fines against a plant processing US hazardous waste to the rollout of a new industrial air-monitoring system, following investigations by the Guardian and Quinto Elemento Lab, a Mexican investigative unit.

Those stories revealed high levels of heavy-metal contamination in the neighborhood around the factory, Zinc Nacional, in the Monterrey metropolitan area, and showed the broader extent of industrial pollution in the region, linked to Monterrey's role in manufacturing and recycling goods for the US market.

Continue reading...

Guest Episode: How To Save a Planet

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

For many people with disabilities, the kitchen can seem a deeply unfriendly place. From counters that require users to stand and cabinets that are often out of reach, to ovens that can't be opened in mobility chairs and tools that are hard to grip or difficult to read—cooking can seem like an impossible challenge. But it doesn't have to be this way. In fact, since the mid-1900s, researchers, designers, and people with disabilities have worked together to reimagine the kitchen in ways that have made it better for all of us. Listen in for this hidden history behind many of your favorite cooking tools, from OXO Good Grips to the Cuisinart food processor, as well as the inspiring stories of how today's blind and disabled cooks have hacked their kitchens to achieve both dinner deliciousness and culinary glory. All that, plus cameos from the household names who turn out to be accessibility legends: Betty Crocker and Julia Child!

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Kale of the Sea

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Call off the search for the new kale: we've found it, and it's called kelp! In this episode of Gastropod, we explore the science behind the new wave of seaweed farms springing up off the New England coast, and discover seaweed's starring role in the peopling of the Americas.

The story of seaweed will take us from a medicine hut in southern Chile to a high-tech seaweed nursery in Stamford, Connecticut, and from biofuels to beer, as we discover the surprising history and bright future of marine vegetables. Along the way, we uncover the role kelp can play in supporting U. S. fishermen, cleaning up coastal waters, and even helping make salmon farms more sustainable. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

How the Carrot Became Orange, and Other Stories

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Guest Episode: Does climate change freak you out? Want to know what we, collectively, can do about it? Us too. How to Save a Planet is a podcast that asks the big questions: what do we need to do to solve the climate crisis, and how do we get it done? Join us, journalist Alex Blumberg and scientist and policy nerd Dr. Ayana Elizabeth Johnson, as we scour the Earth for solutions, talk to people who are making a difference, ask hard questions, crack dumb jokes and — episode by episode — figure out how to build the future we want. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

I discovered three new geckos in Cambodia's limestone caves – and that's not all we found

Pablo Sinovas · The Guardian Environment

The whole ecosystem inside a cave feeds off guano, dead bats, or any dead animals on the ground. It's not for the faint-hearted

It can be daunting entering a cave. It is an underground world that possibly hasn't been explored before. The first smell that hits you is guano (or bat poo). Some of these caves host millions of bats – you can hear them chirping above, hanging in the darkness, and occasionally flying around. It always seems like night-time inside a cave because it's pitch black.

The walls are covered in interesting creatures such as tailless whip scorpions, which look like a cross between a spider and crab (they look dangerous, but are not), as well as millipedes and centipedes. The whole ecosystem feeds off guano, dead bats, or any dead animals on the ground. It's not for the faint-hearted.

Continue reading...

Meet the Queen of Kiwi: the 96-Year-Old Woman Who Transformed America's Produce Aisle

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Thousands of years ago, in what's now Afghanistan, people unearthed the tangled, gnarled roots of Queen Anne's Lace—a ubiquitous, hairy-stemmed plant with a spray of tiny white flowers. These fibrous, twisted roots were white and bitter-tasting, but they had an appealing spicy, pine-y, earthy aroma. This was the unpromising ancestor of one of America's most popular root vegetables (second only to the mighty potato): today, it's mostly consumed in the form of two-inch orange slugs, marketed under the label “baby carrots.” So how did this white, woody root become orange, as well as purple and yellow and even red? Listen in now to find out—and hear the story of the invention of the baby carrot. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Good Shit: How Humanure Could Save Agriculture—and the Planet

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

For most of us, when we sit on the porcelain throne to drop the deuce, priority number one is flushing and never having to think about it again. But it might be time to rethink our stink: all around the world, people are talking about using human waste for good, applying it as fertilizer to grow our food instead of just washing it down the miles of pipes that undergird urban sewage systems. “Ew” is a common response, along with “yuck!” Is using poop to grow food a good idea—or even safe? We're getting our shit together to find out! On this episode of *Gastropod*, how human waste went from being so valuable you could go to jail for stealing it, to causing such a stench it shut down Parliament in Victorian London and led to the invention of the modern sewage system—and why figuring out how to start saving our poop (and pee!) once again could give us cleaner energy, healthier waterways, and lots of delicious food. Listen in now: if you like to eat, it's time to start giving a crap about your crap.

Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Omega 1-2-3 (encore)

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Based on all the hype, you'd be forgiven for believing that the fish oils known as omega-3s are the solution to every problem. Heart disease, dementia, depression, even obesity—the list of ailments that experts claim a daily dose of omega-3 can help prevent seems endless. And with more than ten percent of Americans taking a capsule of fish oil daily, omega-3s are one of the most profitable supplements in the world, too. Listen in this episode, as author Paul Greenberg and scientist JoAnn Manson help us figure out what these supposedly miracle molecules are, and what consuming them is doing to our bodies—and to our oceans. (Encore presentation) Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

ANALYSIS

The produce section of most American supermarkets in the 1950s was minimal to a fault, with only a few dozen fruits and vegetables to choose from: perhaps one kind of apple, one kind of lettuce, a yellow onion, a pile of bananas. Today, grocery stores routinely offer hundreds of different fruits and vegetables, many of which would be unrecognizable to time travelers from a half century ago. What changed, and how did Americans learn to embrace spaghetti squash, sugar snap peas, and kiwi fruit? This episode, we tell the story of the woman behind this transformation: Frieda Caplan, the Queen of Kiwi. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Say Cheese!

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Cheese is the chameleon of the food world, as well as one of its greatest delights. Fresh and light or funky and earthy, creamy and melty or crystalline and crumbly—no other food offers such a variety of flavors and textures.

But cheese is not just a treat for the palate: its discovery changed the course of Western civilization, and, today, cheese rinds are helping scientists conduct cutting-edge research into microbial ecology. In this episode of *Gastropod*, we investigate cheese in all stinking glory, from ancient Mesopotamia to medieval France, from the origins of cheese factories and Velveeta to the growing artisanal cheese movement in the U. S. Along the way, we search for the answer to a surprisingly complex question: what is cheese? Join us as we bust cheese myths, solve cheese mysteries, and put together the ultimate cheese plate. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Death in the Young

Brendan Foht · *The New Atlantis*

In this sad world of ours, sorrow comes to all; and, to the young, it comes with bitterest agony, because it takes them unawares.

— Abraham Lincoln, Letter to Fanny McCullough , December 23, 1862

In war, those with their lives yet to be lived are also those most urgently needed to fight. It is one of the tragic ironies of conflict. In the U. S. Civil War, the average soldier was 26 and approximately 620,000 soldiers died . In World War I, over 2 million German soldiers died, and 40 percent of German combatants were between 21 and 25 years old. In the Vietnam War, 58,193 American servicemen died — approximately 24 percent of those killed were 20, and roughly 17 percent of those killed were 21 . We comprehend the risk in sending young soldiers off to battle: the abrupt cessation of so much potential and promise. It is no less tragic than the death of sons and daughters in any other context, but at least we understand the possible outcome.

But what of the young who do not fight, who expect to live full lives off the battlefield? Alas, forces beyond their control operate surreptitiously; a few dangerous mutations cause a cell to run awry, errant motorists drive recklessly, malfunctioning plane hardware fails mid-air— all of these cut life short in unexpected ways.

In my brief career, I have already seen patients from infancy to young adulthood fall victim to the cruelty of nature. As physicians we don't feel the shock of such events in the same way as the patients' friends and family. We see the patients, we take care of them, we escort them to their end, and then we move on to take care of the next casualty or convalescent.

Dr. Jon Marc Finamore , a 30-year-old colleague and close friend, upended that sense of detachment for me. Jon and I were in the same class in residency and that created a sense of camaraderie. We shared night and weekend calls along with the traditional weekday rotations. We signed out to each other, always commiserating over one frustrating experience or another. During our time off we mulled over a couple of beers with our other friends, running through stories and talking about our future aspirations in medicine.

It was easy to be friends with Jon; sure, he was kind, but his unwavering jovial manner persisted throughout the most difficult moments of our training, always making a dry, hilarious, and self-effacing joke.

When on-call with him, I can think of multiple instances where he would pitch in to help even if it was not his primary responsibility. On one Thanksgiving a couple of years ago, I was covering consult calls in the hospital and was quickly overwhelmed, all while trying to escape home for festivities that evening. When it was clear I would be stuck,

Jon, without asking, started seeing some of my patients. He simply took on some of the burden for me. I got out on time.

These sorts of gestures were evident elsewhere, too. In a social setting, he would turn to our quieter comrades and ask if they were okay with a particular bar or movie and if they had any preferences, such that no one steamrolled anyone else. He looked after everyone but himself, attentive to the smallest amounts of discomfort or dissatisfaction. Even at his bachelor party, while trying to negotiate the wants and needs of his residency friends and everyone else, he asked a few of us if we were fine going to a particular pub everyone else had suggested.

If this was true of Jon with his friends, it was doubly true of Jon with his patients, who were as dedicated to him as he was to them. We sometimes substituted for each other in clinic, if one of us worked nights that week. I saw many of Jon's patients, some of whom were Spanish-speaking (Jon spoke Spanish), and many of them seemed disappointed when I walked into the exam room. Where was Jon? When would he be back? Could I make sure they see him next time?

And despite his easy-going way, Jon also took his studies seriously. He carried around a notebook with him wherever he went, documenting what he learned and saw. When I took over at the VA hospital after his rotation there, I entered the workroom and saw his diagrams of nervous system motor, sensory, and visual pathways drawn on printer paper sitting on the desk. He never let a moment go to waste; he endlessly fed his curiosity.

Amidst this scintillating and effervescent life, something happened to Jon during our third year of residency. His wife, Erica Finamore, Features Editor at Food Network Magazine and The Pioneer Woman Magazine and Jon's eventual champion, writes in a beautiful and moving essay for *Cosmopolitan* about this sudden change. Jon was unable to speak Spanish. He could not find the words. Moreover, he slept almost 19 hours a day, had trouble with recall of facts and figures. He and Erica went to the emergency room, where the doctors there ordered an MRI of Jon's brain.

The news was not good. Imaging revealed a large brain tumor, known as a glioblastoma multiforme . The malignancy wreaks havoc on the mind and the body. Life expectancy, depending on the genetic mutations of the tumor, ranges from 1 to 3 years. The mutations within Jon's tumor were all bad; it was as aggressive as it could possibly be. He hadn't done anything to cause this. It was probably a sporadic mutation. Nature rolled the die for him and this was the outcome.

I cannot possibly imagine what he felt that evening when he looked at the MRI of his brain and knew his diagnosis. As a neurologist, Jon was au fait with his fate from time zero. He had seen his own patients wilt under the weight of this disease as it took away speech, strength, cognition, and eventually all the pneuma of life, with seizures, hospitalizations, chemotherapy, radiation, and surgery as pit stops

Dream Honeymoons to Italy

Anne Gordon · Live Life Travel

Dream Honeymoons to Italy

Our Favorite Italy Destinations for 2019: AMALFI COAST AND SICILY

Belmond Hotel Timeo - Taormina, Italy

While we do not subscribe to the 'one size fits all' theory for any vacation, that especially goes for honeymoons! However, we do have our very favorite Amalfi Coast and Sicily towns as well as the "Best of The Best" hotel and excursion recommendations that should be on the top of everyone's list when planning their Italian getaway.

Amalfi Coast –

SORRENTO is the northern most town on the Amalfi Coast and a great choice if you can only pick one town to visit during your stay on The Amalfi Coast as it serves as a great "home base" if you are unable to take an extended honeymoon. Day trips and excursions are easy from Sorrento including visiting the other coastal cliffside towns, spending a day on the water, taking the ferry over to Capri or even touring the ruins of Pompeii. Sorrento sits upon a cliff and faces the Bay of Naples with stunning views of Mount Vesuvius. There is a town square, Piazza Tasso that is lined with cafes, restaurants and shops along with narrow alleys with lots of hidden gems to be discovered.

Grand Hotel Excelsior Vittoria – Sorrento, Italy

Best of The Best Sorrento Hotel – Grand Hotel Excelsior Vittoria*

One of the most iconic hotels of Italy and it is still owned and managed by the same family (and they live there!). Established in 1834, the hotel was built on the same property where Emperor Augustus had his private villa, so it is possible to see ancient Roman ruins across the five-acre private gardens which is also a paradise of orange, lemon and olive trees, all local staples of the coast. Original antiques, unique rooms, amazing views, a central location, stunning pool, a few restaurants and bars (one Michelin starred) all make this hotel an extremely special place on the Amalfi Coast.

Best of The Best Sorrento Excursion

The Lemon Farm Tour is our favorite, hands down. This half day tour is nothing short of spectacular as you have the opportunity to meet 3 unique Sorrento families and not only learn/watch them do their trade, but also taste/eat/drink/enjoy the results. It is not only delicious, but a very authentic experience and a lot of fun. From the lemon farm with limoncello, lemonade and olive oil to the cheese factory (amazing) and then off to pizza making with the "pizza man."

POSITANO is a village located south of Sorrento and is magically set within a steep cliff lined with narrow streets with a pebble beach along its coastline. Positano is the place to be and be seen and is usually very crowded during high season. There are a lot of great hotels, shopping, boutiques, cafes and bars, the most popular being 'Music on the Rocks.'

John Steinbeck is quoted as saying "Positano bites deep. It is a dream place that isn't quite real when you are there and becomes beckoningly real after you have gone." Harper's Bazaar 1953

Best of the Best Positano Hotel – Le Sirenuse*

Le Sirenuse opened in 1951, when four Neapolitan brothers turned their summer house in to a charming hotel overlooking the bay of Positano. Today, the 58-room boutique hotel is considered one of Italy's best, yet it still retains the intimate and personal feel of a private home.

We recommend enjoying the luxury spa, heated pool along with evening cocktails and great views at the romantic Champagne & Oyster Bar and then top the day off with dinner at Michelin starred restaurant, La Sponda. This infamous restaurant, which also boasts gorgeous sea views, is illuminated in the evening by four hundred candles that create an unforgettable atmosphere, especially for honeymooners.

Palazzo Avio – Ravello, Italy

For those traveling in May and October, you can look forward to somewhat cooler temperatures and fewer crowds. During high season (June through September), we recommend Positano for those couples who want to be in the mix of fun and sun as it becomes a very lively town (sometimes crowded) and very hot during the days. A great pool is essential.

And for those who book Le Sirenuse* with Live Life Travel (3 nights or more) in a Junior Suite or Suite, will receive a complimentary evening sunset cruise with bubbly during your stay. One of our favorite things to do, so an incredible deal.

Best of the Best Positano Excursion

Full Day Private Yacht Charter (and regardless of the wait time, the Blue Grotto is a MUST SEE)

Best of the Best Ravello Hotels

Belmond Hotel Caruso * was formerly an 11th-century palace. Our absolute favorite part of this hotel is the (almost unbelievable) infinity pool that boasts some of the best views in the world. You will also enjoy complimentary boat rides as part of your stay here. This pool is UNREAL!

The truly something unique and special here for honeymooners is the "Infinity Dream Dinner," which is a private candlelight dinner under the stars while floating on the hotel's infinity pool, all with a private butler.

Meet the Man Who Found, Finagled, and Ferried Home the Foods We Eat Today

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

You've probably never heard of David Fairchild. But if you've savored kale, mango, peaches, dates, grapes, a Meyer lemon, or a glass of craft beer lately, you've tasted the fruits of his globe-trotting travels in search of the world's best crops—and his struggles to get them back home to the United States. This episode, we talk to Daniel Stone, author of *The Food Explorer*, a new book all about Fairchild's adventures. Listen in now for tales of pirates and biopiracy, eccentric patrons and painful betrayals, as well as the successes and failures that shaped not only the way we eat, but America's place in the world. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Talking Taco

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Whether or not it's Tuesday, tacos pretty much always hit the spot—and not just in their homeland in Mexico. These days, the taco can be found all over the world, although it's acquired some strange new fillings along the way, from French fries to canned corn. It's hard to imagine something so universal having to be invented—but, in fact, the taco as we know it only emerged in the 1800s. In this episode, Gastropod talks taco with the experts, peering through the salsa-smudged veil of history to answer such questions as: What do Cornish miners and their lunchtime pasties have to do with the taco? Did Glen Bell, of Taco Bell fame, actually invent the hard-shell version? Is a burrito also a taco? And how can a seemingly simple snack harbor so many mysteries? Grab a napkin, because things are going to get messy—and delicious—as we dive deep into the taco-verse to find out!

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Dining at the Top of the World: Arctic Adaptation, Abundance, and...Ice Cream

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Green Gold: Our Love Affair with Olive Oil

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Olive oil is not what you think it is. According to Tom Mueller, author of *Extra Virginity: The Sublime and Scandalous World of Olive Oil*, an olive is a stone fruit like a plum or cherry—meaning that the green-gold liquid we extract from it “is, quite literally, fruit juice.” And, while we're blowing your minds, have you ever stopped to wonder what “Extra Virgin” means? “It's like extra dead or semi-pregnant,” Mueller said. “I mean, it doesn't make any sense at all.” This episode we visit two groves—one in the Old World, one in the New—to get to the bottom of olive oil's many mysteries. Listen in this episode as we find out why the ancient Romans rubbed it all over their bodies, and whether the olive oil on our kitchen counters really is what it says on the label.

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Delivery Wars

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Big tech is changing every aspect of our world. But how? And at what cost? Gastropod is excited to share the first episode of a special four-part *Land of the Giants* series, in which Recode teams up with Eater to unbox the evolving world of food delivery. Find out how the rise of investor-backed third-party delivery apps has dramatically changed consumer behavior, helped create a modern gig workforce, disrupted small businesses, and potentially changed our relationship with food forever.

We need your help! We're conducting an audience survey to hear from you. The information you share is important to help us keep making the podcast and, we hope, keep making it better! Head to Gastropod.com/survey to participate. We really appreciate it.

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Ripe for Global Domination: The Story of the Avocado

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

You may feel like it's cold where you live, but in the Arctic, the average temperature is well below freezing all year round. In winter, it's also pitch black for weeks on end—not an ideal environment for growing food. Still, for thousands of years, people in the Arctic have thrived in a landscape that most outsiders would find fatally inhospitable. This episode, we point our compasses north on a journey to discover how traditional knowledge, ingenuity, and a lot of hard work—combined with genetics and microbes—have allowed the indigenous populations of the far North to not only successfully feed themselves, but also develop a distinctive and remarkable cuisine. Tune in now for the secrets of a dish that feels like Fourth of July fireworks in your mouth, the story of Iceland's second-most famous celebrity (after Björk), and the science behind how to avoid scurvy on an almost vegetable-free diet. Just don't forget your long underwear!

Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

We're coming up to AvocadoFest 2026, otherwise known as the Super Bowl, when Americans get fully a fifth of their annual avocado allocation. But how did this humble fruit, originally named after testicles, get from its Mexican forest home to a tattoo on Miley Cyrus's upper arm? This episode, we unravel the avocado's amazing journey, a story that involves not only conquistadors and cartel violence, but also a Southern California postman and actress Angie Dickinson lounging in a white leotard. And we discover where the avocado is headed next—a place where it's known as the butter fruit, and often consumed in shake form. Listen in now for all this creamy green goodness and more. (encore) Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Eating to Win: Gatorade, Muscle Milk, and... Chicken Nuggets?

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley · Gastropod

Ancient Greek Olympians swore by beans to give them a competitive edge. Japanese sumo wrestlers rely on a protein-rich soup called chankonabe to get into peak condition. And NBA all-stars Kevin Garnett, Carmelo Anthony, and Steph Curry credit their success to a pre-game PB&J. Throughout history, athletes have traditionally eaten something special they hope will give them an edge. But is there any science behind these special drinks and diets—and will consuming them help those of us who are not destined for sporting glory, too? Listen in this episode as we reveals the backstory behind such stadium staples as Gatorade and Muscle Milk—and the evidence for their efficacy. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

BRIEFS

Annemarie Dooling, Bon Appétit (magazine): After a year-long refresh, the restaurant reopened with a 3,800-bottle display, and even the line cooks can recommend God-tier bottles.

Steph Saltzman, Fashionista: For our Weekly Drop Watch column, Fashionista scours the market to curate the most noteworthy releases from our favorite fashion and beauty brands. Keep scrolling for this week's highlights. Dôen partnered with eyewear brand Garrett Leight on a line of summer-ready sunglasses. Developed ...

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Catie Pusateri, Fashionista: Back in 2022, Deciem (the Canada-based incubator behind Gen Z's favorite skin-care brand The Ordinary) discontinued The Chemistry Brand, along with HIF, Hylamide and Abnomaly. Nearly four years later, the company is relaunching The Chemistry Brand on April 2 with the return of its hero SKU, Hand ...

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Beguile, Fashionista: If you've noticed a shimmering, warm trail of scent in the front row this season, you're not imagining it. While the industry often chases the loudest new launch, insiders are gravitating toward something far more intimate. Enter Golden Kiss, a fragrance from Beguile that doesn't sit on the skin so ...

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Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley, Gastropod: It's nearly the Day of the Dead in Mexico, which gives us the perfect excuse to get familiar with the country's national spirit: tequila. Or wait, should that be mezcal? And what's the difference, anyway? In this episode of Gastropod, Cynthia and Nicky travel to Mexico to explore the history and science of distilled agave, and get tangled up in a complex story of controversies, clones, and culture. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Catie Pusateri, Fashionista: These are the stories making headlines in fashion on Friday. H&M Group unveiled its Annual & Sustainability Report for 2025 on Thursday, which showed a 34.6% reduction in Scope 3 greenhouse gas emissions compared to 2019 levels. The company added that 91% of its materials are recycled ...

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Stu Davidson, Stuck in Customs: One from a semi recent trip around the NZ fjords...

The post Exploring the Fjords appeared first on Stuck in Customs .

Steph Saltzman, Fashionista: For our Weekly Drop Watch column, Fashionista scours the market to curate the most noteworthy releases from our favorite fashion and beauty brands. Keep scrolling for this week's highlights Lee and J. Crew partnered on a denim-focused capsule collection, "bring[ing] two legends of American style ...

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Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley, Gastropod: For decades, ads for treats sweetened with substances like Sweet'N Low, NutraSweet, and Splenda have promised what seems like a miracle of modern science: that you can enjoy all the dessert you want, calorie-free. No need to deprive yourself—with artificial sweeteners, you can literally have your cake and eat it, too. But are these substances safe? Don't they give cancer to rats and mess up your metabolism? Listen in now for answers to all these questions, plus the tale of a sugar-free gumball marketing blitz, courtesy of none other than Donald Rumsfeld. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley, Gastropod: Is white chocolate really chocolate? What causes asparagus pee? Sprinkles or jimmies—which do you call them, and is the term 'jimmies' racist? Why is the heat of mustard and wasabi so different from a chile burn? This episode, Gastropod is getting to the bottom of your most pressing questions—which also means diving into some of the internet's most controversial food debates. Listen in now as we call in historians and scientists to bust myths, solve mysteries, and find out why some people turn asparagus into the devil's own brew! Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley, Gastropod: Many people only think of maple syrup at the breakfast table, when they're facing down a stack of hot, fluffy pancakes or some French toast. They're missing out. Maple is undergoing a major boom, newly ascendant in beverage aisles, Asian kitchens, and even biomedical research laboratories. In this episode, we visit sugar shacks and talk to the experts to find out why tree sap is so hot right now—and whether it can live up to the hype.

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Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley, Gastropod: If you haven't tasted kombucha yet, you probably will soon. The sour-sweet, fizzy, fermented tea is becoming ubiquitous in trendy cafes, workplaces, and health food stores across America. Where did it come from, and how did it get so popular? And what in the world is the slimy, beige blob that produces it? From German POWs to Lindsey Lohan to a kombucha zoo at Tufts University, this episode explores the history and science of summer's hottest drink. Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

Jessica Sulima, Condé Nast Traveler: Whether you're planning a weekend getaway or a cross-country trip, save on your next vehicle with these Hertz discount codes and member-exclusive offers.

Cynthia Graber and Nicola Twilley, Gastropod: Cue the dramatic music, it's quiz time: Can you identify the people behind these catchphrases? "Yum-O!" "Pukka!" "Bam!" "Peace, love, and taco grease!" The answers are below—but if you've already caught on, then you're well aware of how entrenched TV chefs are in mainstream pop culture. But how did a medium where you can't actually smell or taste the food get so popular? What was the very first food TV show, and how has food TV changed—and changed us? Learn more about your ad choices. Visit podcastchoices.com/adchoices

The Swift Herald

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